Family Interest Survey Results

What Senn families told us matters most for parent engagement programming

Collected March 12-19, 2026 | Report Card Pick-Up Activation

100+ Total Responses	**7x** vs Last Year	**5+** Languages	**85%** Want to Stay Connected
85+ Emails Collected	**85+** Phone #s Collected	**~45** Want to Get Involved	**~40** Want to Be Informed

Context

Last year: 14 responses. This year: 100+ in a single afternoon at Report Card Pick-Up (March 18). Languages: English, Spanish, Kinyarwanda, Swahili. Nearly every respondent provided email and phone, giving the PAC a real contact list.

What Drove the Results

The biggest driver was coordinating with teachers and admins behind the report card tables, briefing them to direct parents to the PAC table. Having the survey on sennparents.com so parents could scan and complete on their phones also made a significant impact. A laptop was available as backup, but most parents preferred their own devices. The lesson: staff coordination beats any single tactic.

KEY FINDING

Top 3 Parent Priorities

Parents picked their top 3 topics. These results directly inform how Title I parent engagement funds should be allocated.

#1

College & Career Planning

College apps, FAFSA, financial aid, career pathways

#2

Mental Health & Well-Being

Student emotional health, warning signs, resources

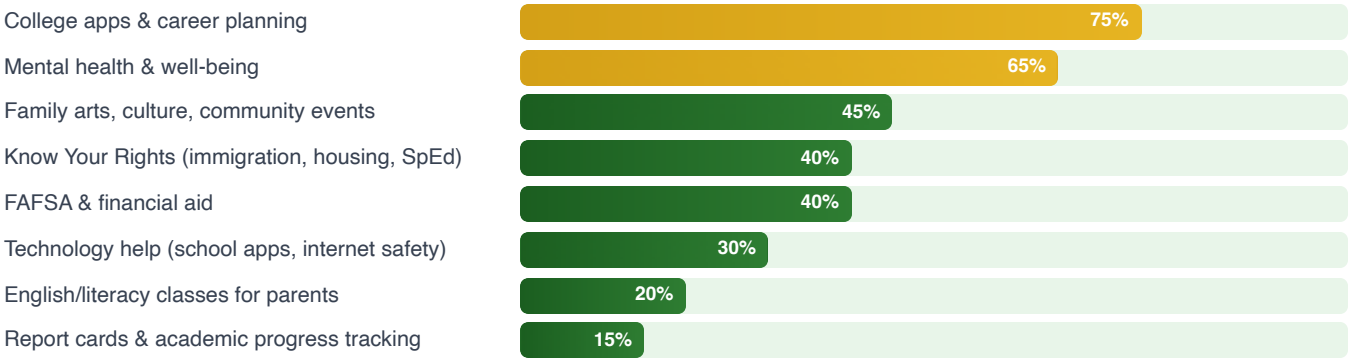
#3

Know Your Rights

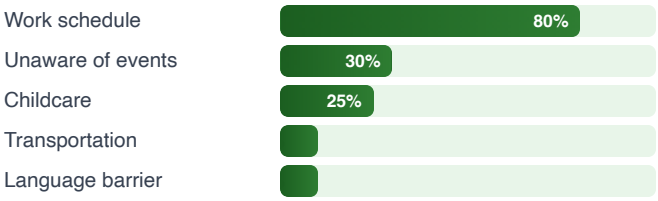
Immigration, housing, special education rights

TOPICS What Should the PAC Focus On? (Full Breakdown)

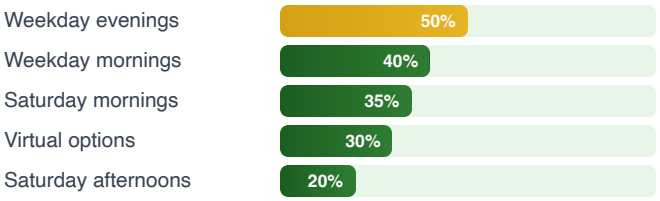
Based on 20-response sample. Percentages reflect how often each topic appeared in parent selections (each parent chose up to 3).



BARRIERS What Makes It Hard to Participate?



SCHEDULING When Can Parents Attend?



AWARENESS Had You Heard of the PAC?

Response	%
Yes	55%
No	45%

Nearly half learned about the PAC for the first time at Report Card Pick-Up.

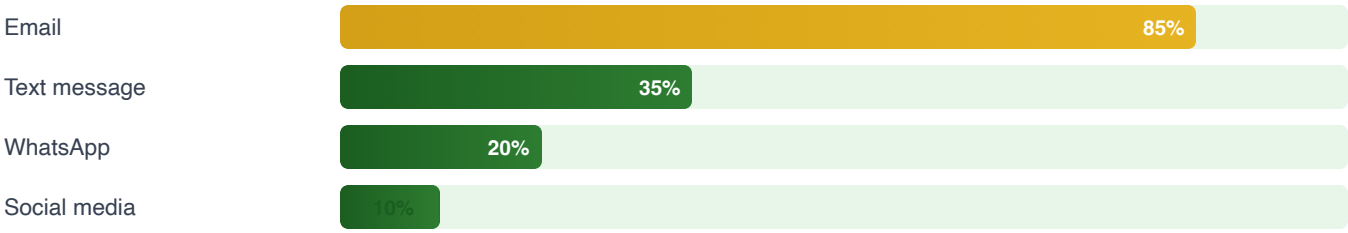
ENGAGEMENT Want to Stay Connected?

Response	%
Yes, get involved!	45%
Keep me informed	40%
Not at this time	15%

85% of respondents want ongoing connection with the PAC.

COMMUNICATION

How Parents Want to Hear From Us



Title I Funding Context

Grant #430329 (Fund 332) Title I PAC funds are NOT subject to the April 8 general spending deadline. However, with the last day of school being June 4, 2026, all parent activities and training sessions should be scheduled throughout April and May.

RECOMMENDATIONS

What the Data Tells Us to Do

- **Schedule workshops in the evening.** Work schedule is the #1 barrier (80%). Weekday evenings (4-8 PM) are the most accessible time for the majority of parents.
- **Always offer a virtual option.** 30% of parents said virtual works best for their schedule. Use Zoom for hybrid access to every event.
- **Prioritize college and career planning.** This was the #1 topic chosen by 75% of respondents. FAFSA and financial aid was also ranked highly (40%), especially among 11th and 12th grade parents.
- **Address mental health.** The #2 priority at 65%. Partner with a CPS-approved wellness vendor like SEL Chicago, Wellness For Everyone, or Youth Guidance.
- **Run a Know Your Rights session.** 40% selected this, particularly families who speak languages other than English. Bilingual facilitation is essential.
- **Invest in outreach and awareness.** 45% had never heard of the PAC before this survey. 30% said "unaware of events" is a barrier. Email is the dominant channel (85%), but text and WhatsApp are important for multilingual families.
- **Build a community event.** 45% want family arts, culture, and community events. This builds trust and brings in families who might not attend a formal workshop.
- **Plan for multilingual programming.** Survey respondents speak English, Spanish, Kinyarwanda, Swahili, and other languages. Translation and culturally responsive facilitation are not optional.

NEXT STEPS

Action Plan: April - June 2026

Action	Timeline	Owner
Workshop vote open on sennparents.com/vote	Now - April 20	Steve (Outreach)
Share vote results at PAC meeting	April 21	Jason (Chair)
Schedule workshop based on survey results	Week of April 21	PAC Officers, Principal